Dear Hiring Team at Halden Pay,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform position. In my current role at Lukovac Freight Hub, I own ingestion and orchestration across Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka, including documented, tested and incremental data models. I am interested in bringing this experience to Halden Pay's Data Platform team, particularly its focus on reliable, reusable capabilities for analytics and product use cases.

I have delivered production pipelines at scale, including a shipment-event streaming pipeline processing around 30 million events per day with end-to-end latency under two minutes at p95. I also replaced hourly full-table extracts with Debezium change data capture, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%, and migrated around 300 stored procedures into documented, tested dbt models, introducing incremental models and clearer lineage. That work reduced the nightly warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. I have also optimised Snowflake usage through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removal of unused tables, reducing monthly costs from approximately $38,000 to $24,000 in 2024. My experience includes Python and SQL, Airflow, dbt, Kafka and Snowflake, alongside comparable cloud data-platform services including AWS EMR, S3, Glue Data Catalog and Redshift.

My earlier experience at Kovalent Pay is especially relevant to Halden Pay's payments business. I built PySpark jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile bank settlement files against internal ledgers, reducing finance's manual month-end reconciliation work from approximately three days to four hours. I also worked on Redshift warehouse design and data quality using Great Expectations. Alongside my production work, I have contributed two merged pull requests, including a pagination fix and tests, to an Apache Airflow provider, and presented on data contracts at a regional data meetup. I enjoy taking ownership of practical improvements, sharing knowledge and simplifying systems so teams can work more reliably and quickly.

I hold an MSc in Computer Science from Northgate Technical University, with a thesis on incremental materialized views, and am an AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience building and improving data platforms could contribute to Halden Pay's Data Platform team through reliable ingestion, data modelling and warehouse transformation, data quality, and platform improvements.

Kind regards,
Lena Varga-Holm